load balancer saved us a lot of time. We invested this time in automating the testing and operations for our entire infrastructure.

The changes that took place during this transformation to the cloud went beyond the technical. After a while, the software architecture changed from a monolithic application to microservices, and the separation between software development and operations got very blurry—and, in some cases, disappeared altogether. Instead, we built our organization around the core principle of DevOps: you build it, you run it.

Since 2015, we have worked as independent consultants, helping our clients get the most out of AWS. We have accompanied startups, midsized companies, and enterprise corporations on their journey to the cloud. Along the way, we have identified—and solved—the common challenges that confront companies of all sizes as they move to the cloud. In fact, we ended up turning some of our solutions into products to sell on the AWS Marketplace.

We enjoyed writing the first edition of our book in 2015. The astonishing support from Manning and our MEAP readers allowed us to finish the whole book in only nine months. Above all, it was a pleasure to observe you—our readers—using our book to get started with AWS or deepen your knowledge with the platform.

AWS is always innovating and constantly releasing new features or whole new services. So, in 2018, we released a second edition of the book, updated and revised based on the feedback of our readers. The second edition added three more chapters to cover newer developments—Lambda, EFS, and ElastiCache—and updated all the previous chapters.